

MEDILAB

Home Sample Collection Service Policy

Knowledge Base Category: Services

Document Type	Customer-facing process / policy guidance
Intended Use	RAG knowledge retrieval and website reference
Version	1.0 - Assessment Dataset
Clinical Boundary	Operational information only; not clinical advice

Operational policy for booking, preparing for, and completing home sample collection visits.

Quick Reference

Use this document for	Do not use this document for
Stable customer-service process, policy, preparation, FAQ, and operational guidance.	Live prices, slot availability, booking status, patient-specific clinical interpretation, diagnosis, or medication advice.

1. Service Overview

MediLab home sample collection allows eligible patients to have approved laboratory specimens collected at a residential or other permitted address. Availability depends on the service area, test eligibility, collector capacity, and the requested time slot.

A home collection visit is a specimen-collection service. It does not replace medical consultation, emergency care, or clinical assessment.

2. Eligibility and Service Area

Home collection is offered only for tests and specimen types approved for mobile collection. Some tests may require equipment, processing, observation, or handling that is available only at a branch or laboratory facility.

The booking address must fall inside an active home-service area. Service-area coverage is a business rule and may change; current coverage should be checked from the trusted service-area source rather than inferred from an old conversation.

3. Booking Information Required

A home visit requires the patient name, contact number, collection address, requested tests or package, preferred date and time slot, and any access instructions needed to reach the patient. Additional information may be required for minors, authorized representatives, or special access arrangements.

The booking is not confirmed until the required fields are validated, an eligible slot is reserved, and the system returns a real booking reference after the database transaction succeeds.

4. Before the Visit

The patient should review any test-preparation instruction in advance. If fasting is required, follow the approved preparation guide. Keep a valid identification document available when required by the workflow and ensure the collector can access the address safely.

For apartment buildings, gated communities, offices, or locations with security control, the patient should provide access details and remain reachable by phone around the scheduled arrival window.

5. Arrival Window and Delays

Home visits are scheduled in service windows because travel time, traffic, prior collections, and specimen-handling requirements can affect arrival. The booking confirmation should show the applicable slot or window.

If the collector is delayed, MediLab should provide an updated estimate when available. Customer service must not promise an exact arrival time that is not supported by live operational data.

6. Identity Verification and Consent

Before collection, the collector verifies the patient identity against the booking and order. For minors or patients requiring an authorized representative, the responsible adult or authorized person must be available as required by the service workflow.

If identity or consent cannot be verified, collection may be postponed or cancelled rather than proceeding with uncertain information.

7. Collection and Specimen Handling

The collector uses approved single-use collection supplies and follows the test-specific collection requirements. Specimens are labeled after identity confirmation and prepared for transport according to the relevant handling requirement.

The customer-facing process should explain that samples are transported under controlled laboratory procedures. Detailed internal technical handling instructions remain part of laboratory SOPs and are not improvised by customer service.

8. Failed or Incomplete Collection

A collection may be incomplete if the required specimen cannot be obtained, the patient is not prepared, identity cannot be verified, the order is unavailable, or the test is not eligible for mobile collection.

The next step may be recollection, branch collection, or rescheduling. Customer service should record the operational reason and provide the approved next option without making clinical judgments.

9. Rescheduling, Cancellation, and No-Show

Home collection visits may be cancelled or rescheduled up to 4 hours before the scheduled slot under the standard MediLab policy. Changes after that point may be subject to service-specific conditions defined in the current booking policy.

If the patient is unreachable, absent, or access to the location is not possible, the visit may be recorded as unsuccessful or no-show. A new slot is not guaranteed until a new booking is confirmed.

10. Safety and Service Limitations

Collectors may stop or decline a visit if the location is unsafe, access is not reasonably possible, aggressive behavior occurs, or the service cannot be completed safely.

For emergencies, urgent symptoms, or requests for medical assessment, customer service should direct the patient to an appropriate healthcare professional or emergency service rather than using the home-collection workflow.

Document Control Notes

- This is a fictional MediLab assessment document designed to resemble real diagnostic-laboratory customer-service documentation.
- If a live structured record conflicts with this document, the structured record controls for price, availability, booking, status, and test-specific catalog values.
- If a future policy changes, update the KnowledgeDocument version and reindex the RAG corpus so stale chunks are removed.
- Customer service must not use this document to diagnose, clinically interpret results, prescribe medication, or recommend medically necessary tests from symptoms.